

# Colchester Castle — Discovery Challenge

Self-guided visit · Work in pairs · Speak English throughout!

Name:

Partner:

## Rules

- Work in pairs — discuss every question before writing.
- Speak English only.
- Read the panels carefully before answering.
- Ask museum staff politely if you need help: *"Excuse me, could you help us find...?"*

## Stop 1

## Outside the Castle — Before entering

### ★ Scavenger hunt — find and tick:

- ☐ An arch
- ☐ A tower
- ☐ A Roman brick (look for thin, reddish bricks mixed into the wall)

Draw one thing you can see:

*Draw here*

### ★★ Q1. What material is the castle mainly made from?

### ★★ Q2. How old is the castle approximately?

- ☐ 200 years
- ☐ 500 years
- ☐ 900 years
- ☐ 2,000 years

### ★★★ Q3. Why do you think the castle was built to look so strong?

## Stop 2

## The Roman Foundations

*Colchester was once the Roman capital of Britain.*

### ★ Scavenger hunt — find these objects and tick:

- ☐ A coin
- ☐ A helmet or weapon
- ☐ A piece of pottery

★ My favourite object: \_\_\_\_\_

It is \_\_\_\_\_ (*old / beautiful / strange / interesting*).

### ★★ Q4. What was the Roman name of Colchester?

### ★★ Q5. Why was this city important to the Romans?

### ★★★ Q6. Find one Roman object and describe it:

Object: \_\_\_\_\_

Material: \_\_\_\_\_

What it was used for: \_\_\_\_\_

### ★★★ Challenge: find the oldest thing in this room. What is it?

## Stop 3

## Boudica and the Revolt

*Read the information panels about Boudica.*

### ★ Q7. Who was Boudica? Tick the correct answer:

- ☐ A Roman empress
- ☐ A British queen who fought the Romans
- ☐ A Norman knight

### ★★ Q8. Why did she attack Colchester?

### ★★★ Q9. Do you think her rebellion was justified? Why?

💬 **Discussion:** Would you call Boudica a hero or a rebel? Discuss with your partner — you don't have to agree!

## Stop 4

## Norman Power — After 1066

★ Find and draw one Norman feature (an arch, a column, a carved stone):

*Draw here*

★★ Q10. Who ordered the building of the castle?

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★★ Q11. Why did the Normans build castles in England? Tick 2:

- ☐ To defend against attack
- ☐ To show power
- ☐ To grow food
- ☐ To control people

★★★ Q12. How is Norman architecture different from Roman architecture? Find one example of each.

Roman example: \_\_\_\_\_

Norman example: \_\_\_\_\_

## Stop 5

## The Prison Cells

★ Find and tick:

- ☐ A prison door
- ☐ Something that would make prison life difficult

★★ Q13. How were prisoners treated?

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★★ Q14. Would you like to spend one night here? Explain in 2–3 sentences.

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★★★ Q15. Find one surprising fact about prison life here:

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💬 **Discussion:** Was justice fair in the past? What has changed since then?

## Stop 6

## Final Reflection — The Castle from Outside

⚠ *The roof is not accessible today. Answer from ground level or from the highest point you can reach inside.*

★★ Q16. Why was this castle built in this location? Think about what you have seen today.

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★★ Q17. What do you think you would be able to see from the top of the castle? List 4 things:

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_

★★★ Q18. If you were a Norman king or queen, would you choose this castle as your base?  
Why?

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★ **Complete these sentences:**

The castle is \_\_\_\_\_ (*big / enormous / impressive / ancient*).

My favourite part of the visit was \_\_\_\_\_

One thing I did not know before today: \_\_\_\_\_

### After the visit — optional oral task

Prepare a 2-minute presentation: "*Why is Colchester Castle important in British history?*"

Use: past tenses · historical vocabulary · your own opinion.